

Linked [®] **CASE STUDY**

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LINKEDIN: THE LOCATION TRANSPARENCY GAP

LinkedIn excels at connecting talent to opportunity, but it fails to connect talent to “*place*”. After interviewing power-users, a critical friction point was discovered in the application process funnel.

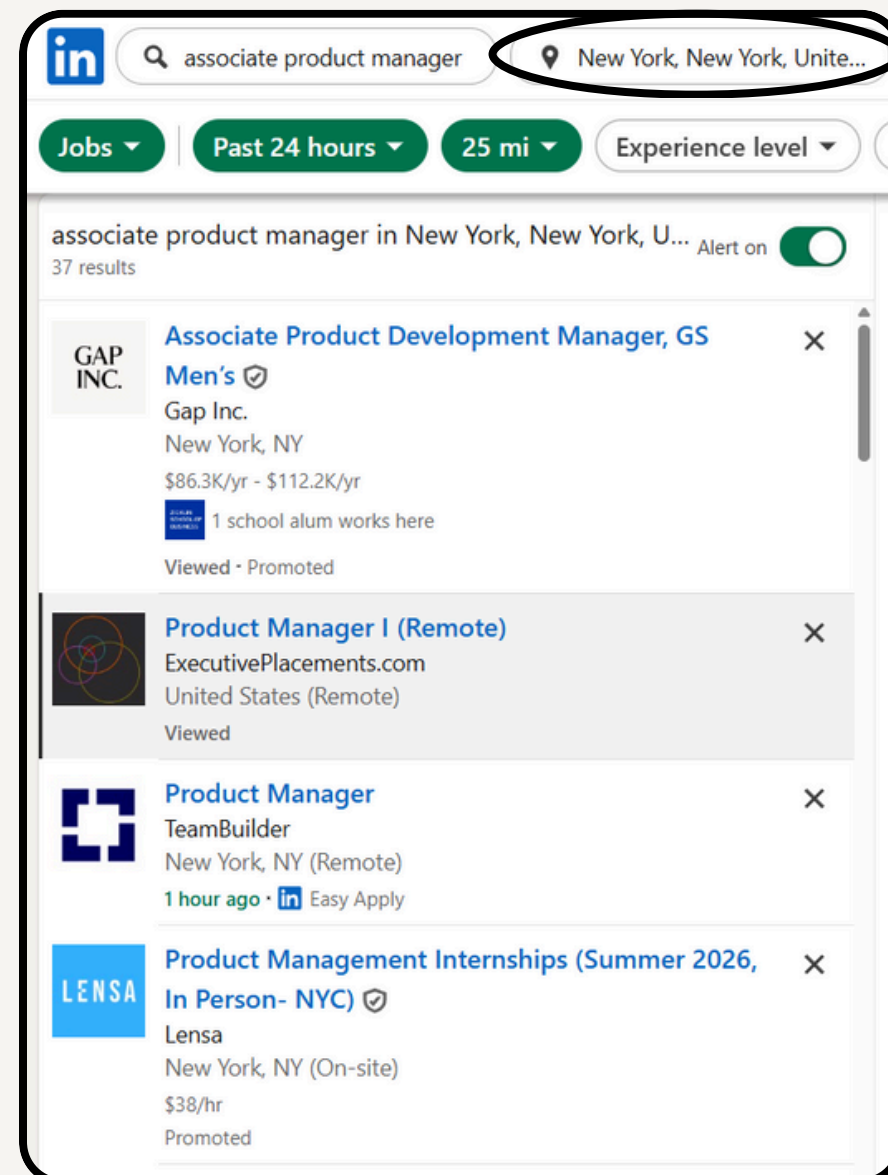
The Blind Application. Candidates are forced to apply first and assess commute viability second, breaking the funnel for everyone.



The 2 Core Frictions

1. The "Blind Application" Friction: Generic location labels create an information vacuum. For locals, this forces a "App Hop" to verify commute. For relocators, it hides critical "Life Context" (housing costs, school districts, safety), delaying deal-breaker decisions until they get a screening call or later interview stages.

2. Hybrid Ambiguity Friction: As companies shift back to in-person work, distance has become relative to frequency. A 90-minute commute is acceptable once a week, but quite hard to manage three times a week. Current filters miss this nuance, failing to account for the critical frequency vs distance trade-off.



Low-Fidelity Data: Vague labels that hide critical commute and lifestyle context.

THE EVIDENCE: QUANTIFYING THE LOCATION GAP



Primary Research (Internal Discovery)

A total of **50** active LinkedIn Jobseekers were surveyed or interviewed for this case study. We wanted to make sure that this user pain point is not just a subjective matter but something that is more common. Some **quotes** from the interviews are as follows:

"I applied to a 'Hybrid' role thinking it was in Midtown. Turns out it was in Jersey City. On a map, that's 5 miles. In reality, that's an extra hour of transit. I felt tricked into applying." — Data Analyst, Finance

"I'm not just looking for a job; I'm moving my family. 'Greater Austin Area' tells me nothing." — Senior Engineer, Relocating



Market Validation (Industry Benchmarks)

Market research shows that unclear locations have a real cost. It drives away applicants and causes higher staff turnover.

The Data:

62%

Funnel Drop-off: Candidates who have declined to apply specifically due to commute uncertainty. (Source: Scoop "State of the American Commute")

23%

Quit Rate: Workers who have resigned because the commute reality didn't match their expectations. (Source: Robert Half Survey)

85%

Retention Risk: Employees with commutes >45 mins face significantly higher turnover (Source: ERE Media).



THE FIX: GEOSPATIAL SEARCH & DISCOVERY

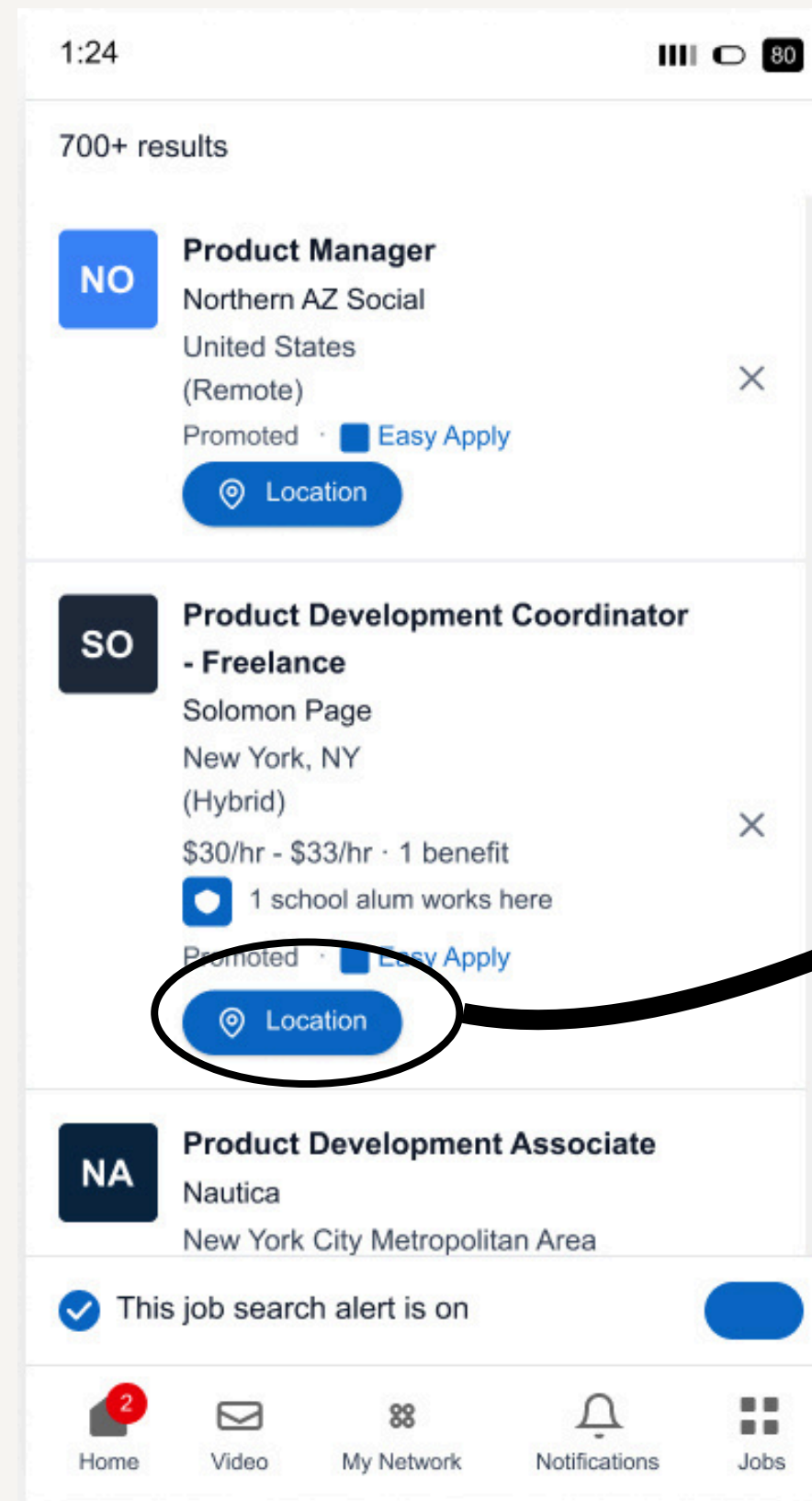
We've established that the data gap exists. So, how do we close it without rebuilding the entire app? We introduce **LinkedIn Location Intelligence**, a geospatial layer that sits on top of the existing job feed.

Screen 01:

We replace the static text flow with a "Location" toggle directly on the job card. This functions as a "Geospatial Gateway," allowing users to instantly validate the location of a specific role without leaving their search session.

Screen 02:

Tapping the Location CTA activates an interactive map overlay. It clusters open roles relative to the user's location, revealing density, transit access, and neighborhood data that is currently hidden by generic text labels.



Screen 1



Screen 2



TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE & FEASIBILITY

In order to implement this feature, we leverage three distinct Google Maps APIs to handle backend geocoding and frontend visualization. This approach ensures high-fidelity data without compromising app performance. The following section dives into the technical architecture behind this feature.

The Data (Geocoding API)



What It Does: Translates messy text addresses (like "350 5th Ave, NY") into exact map coordinates.

Why We Need It: You can't put text on a map. This step turns "words" into "pins." It's the mandatory first step that lets us show exactly where a job is located instead of just listing a generic city name.

The Privacy (Client-Side Processing)

What It Does: Keeps location data on the user's phone, not on the servers.

Why We Need It: Trust is non-negotiable. This setup ensures that while users get better location context, recruiters never see where a candidate lives. They only see that the candidate applied. It's 100% private and compliant.

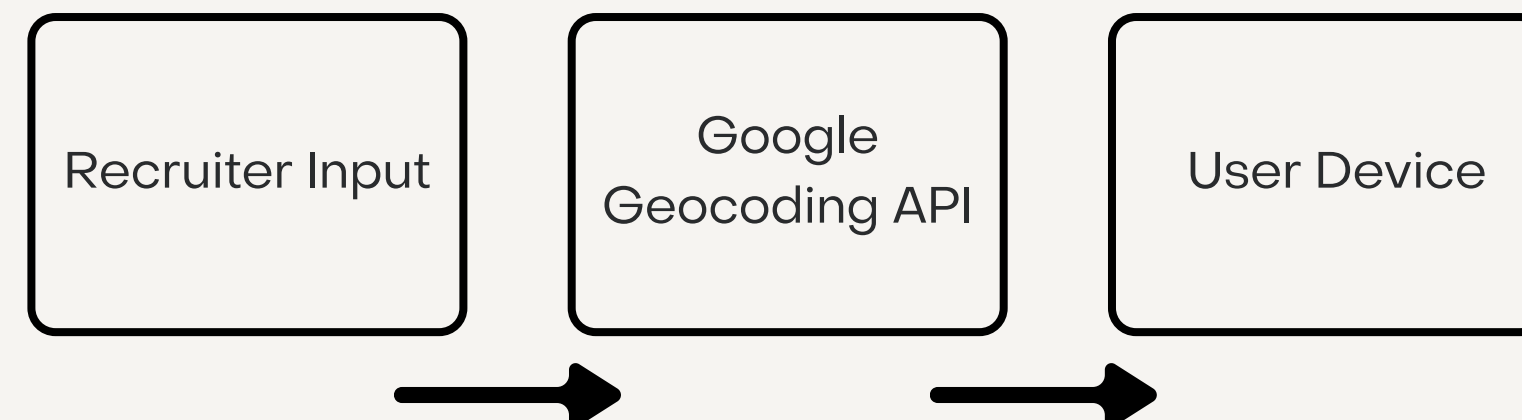
The Display (Maps JavaScript + Static API)



What It Does: Controls what the user actually sees.

Why We Need It: Interactive maps are heavy and can slow down the app. To keep things fast, we use lightweight "snapshot" images while you scroll the job list. We only load the full, interactive map when you actually tap to explore.

Data Flow Diagram



SUCCESS METRICS & STRATEGIC RISKS

KPIs

To Track



1

North Star Metric: Application Conversion Rate

We should see an increase in the % of users who click "Apply" after viewing a job description.

2

Feature Adoption: Map Interaction Rate

Track the % of unique job searches that toggle the "Map View" or tap a map pin.

3

Guardrail Metric: Latency / Load Time

Maintain search result load times under 200ms.



Risk Assessment

Why hasn't this been done yet? Three points come to mind.

1. Data Privacy

Handling sensitive user data (Home Location) creates a potential security vulnerability. Additionally, companies (e.g., stealth startups) may not want to reveal their exact office address.

2. API Cost Scale

A high volume of dynamic map loads could become expensive.

3. Geocoding Accuracy

Large enterprises often post jobs under a generic 'HQ' address, even if the role is at a satellite office or remote. Geocoding the HQ by default could mislead candidates.

Timeline



PHASE 1

(2 months)

Focus: "Compliance & Design"



PHASE 2

(2 months)

Focus: "Engineering Implementation"



PHASE 3

(2 months)

Focus: "Go-to-Market"

